

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Incident Response | Threat Hunting | Detection Engineering | SIEM | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience in cyber incident response, threat hunting, and detection engineering across complex enterprise environments. I have a proven track record of investigating and managing serious security incidents end-to-end, including ransomware, data breaches, phishing campaigns, and insider threat scenarios, working in accordance with NIST SP 800-61 and the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I bring deep practical expertise across Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms including Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), with strong skills in KQL-based detection rule authoring, monitoring gap identification, and proactive threat hunting across cloud, endpoint, network, and identity environments. I have supported junior analysts and acted as a subject matter expert (SME) in security operations, with experience in designing and operationalising detection capabilities, building response runbooks, and driving continuous improvement in Security Operations Centre (SOC) maturity. I am an effective communicator who bridges technical depth with clear, stakeholder-facing reporting, and I am ready to contribute immediately to a high-calibre legal sector cyber security team.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Cyber Incident Response:** End-to-end incident management (detection, triage, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review); NIST SP 800-61; serious incident handling including ransomware, data breach, phishing, and insider threat
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hunting across endpoint, network, identity, and cloud telemetry using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel; hypothesis-driven and IOC-based hunt methodologies
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL detection rule design and tuning in Microsoft Sentinel; CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; custom Indicator of Attack (IOA) rule development; identification and remediation of monitoring gaps
- **SIEM / SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (Azure Sentinel), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; SOAR playbook development and automation; alert triage and case management
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR/Prevent, Insight, Discover, Spotlight); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Identity Threat Detection:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID anomaly investigation; Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); CVSS-based risk prioritisation
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust (session recording, password vaulting, just-in-time access)
- **Frameworks:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL; Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) integrations
- **Additional:** Microsoft Sentinel, Mimecast, Check Point Harmony, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned playbooks; mentoring and analyst development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer – University of the Arts, London (UArL) | March 2025 – Present
Responsible for investigating and managing serious security incidents from initial triage through containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review; handle ransomware, data breach, phishing, account compromise, and insider threat scenarios.

- Design and execute proactive threat hunting operations across endpoint, identity, network, and cloud environments using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel; identify adversary techniques mapped to MITRE ATT&CK and develop hunt hypotheses based on threat intelligence.
- Engineer detection rules and KQL-based analytics in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; identify monitoring gaps in log coverage and alerting logic; develop and maintain SOAR playbooks to automate response actions and reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Mentor and support junior cyber security analysts, providing guidance on alert investigation methodology, incident handling, and tool usage; act as a technical subject matter expert (SME) for escalated security events.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR: policy configuration and tuning, custom Indicator of Attack (IOA) development, and continuous review of detection coverage to reduce false-positive rates.
- Manage identity-related threat detection using Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Azure AD / Entra ID, investigating anomalous authentication behaviour, lateral movement, and privilege escalation attempts.
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io and AppCheck; validate control effectiveness through Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) testing; produce risk-based remediation reports for senior stakeholders.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM): session recording, password vaulting, just-in-time access provisioning and privileged account lifecycle management.
- Contribute to security capability improvement projects, including updating runbooks, refining escalation pathways, and introducing detection engineering best practices aligned to MITRE ATT&CK.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity – University of the Arts London (UAL)

- Investigated and managed security incidents across the University of the Arts London through root-cause analysis and post-incident review; applied NIST SP 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK frameworks throughout. *March 2022 – March 2025*
- Performed SIEM alert triage, investigation and escalation using Microsoft Sentinel, with ongoing development of KQL detection rules and SOAR automation to improve analyst efficiency and detection fidelity.
- Led a full Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) rollout across 8,000 users, improving end-to-end endpoint visibility and enabling faster incident detection and response.
- Conducted regular threat hunting exercises across cloud, endpoint and network telemetry, identifying previously undetected threats and contributing findings to detection rule improvements.
- Supported junior analysts with alert triage, investigation guidance, and skill development, fostering a continuous-improvement culture within the security operations team.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Azure AD / Entra ID for identity threat detection; investigated anomalous sign-in behaviour, privilege abuse, and lateral movement indicators.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Tenable Nessus and AppCheck; managed remediation tracking through change control workflows; briefed technical leads on risk exposure.
- Updated security incident response procedures, detection playbooks, and controls documentation in line with ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, and NIST CSF.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure – HICX Solutions Ltd (SeeS/FinTech)

- Investigated and managed security incidents across endpoint and network infrastructure, escalated incidents and supported response activities in line with documented procedures. *February 2021 – March 2022*
- Implemented endpoint security controls, Identity and Access Management (IAM), MFA and SSO for cloud-hosted applications, contributing to Zero Trust access enforcement.
- Performed vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation with infrastructure teams, maintaining risk register documentation.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance and security policy development, including risk assessment and controls review activities.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led management of multiple serious cyber security incidents including ransomware, data breach, and account compromise events, achieving containment and recovery within agreed recovery time objectives and producing detailed post-incident reports for executive stakeholders.

- Built and operationalised a proactive threat hunting programme using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying previously undetected adversary activity and translating hunt findings into permanent detection rule improvements.
- Engineered KQL-based detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced false-positive alert volume, enabling the analyst team to focus on genuine high-fidelity threats.
- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) rollout across 8,000 users, significantly improving endpoint visibility and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for endpoint threats.
- Mentored junior analysts in investigation methodology, tool usage and incident handling best practices, contributing to measurable improvements in team response capability and analyst confidence.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 80,000–90,000 | Hybrid (London)